Contact

Leiria, Portugal
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Top Skills

Product Design
Design Systems
Product Strategy

Languages

Portuguese (Native or Bilingual)
French (Elementary)
Spanish (Elementary)
English (Full Professional)

Certifications

Object-Oriented UX Fundamentals
Cultivating Creative Collaboration
AI x Design Thinking

Honors-Awards

"Break the Spell" Exhibition
"Break the Spell" Design Prize
"Boeing 345" Exhibition
"Show Windows" Design Prize
"Martini Glasses" Design Prize

Pedro MC Fernandes

Experienced Product Designer | Systems Thinker | Enterprise 0→1 Strategy & Code-Shipping | 18+ Years Building & Scaling
Leiria, Leiria, Portugal

Summary

I'm a systems-thinking product designer who transforms stagnating products into growth engines by fixing ecosystems, not just interfaces.

I operate at the intersection of strategy and execution, defining a vision that influences executive roadmaps while shipping production code that helps scale teams and operations. My specialty is diagnosing why products underperform, then building the frameworks and systems that unlock their potential.

At Percona, I helped upkeep and then amplify product adoption growth by identifying the underlying problems, beyond UI cosmetics, and systematizing core, scalable fixes that slowly start to scaffold. At Farfetch, I shifted sustainability from being costly to being a business opportunity by revealing how shopping discovery barriers created vicious cycles.

I thrive in ambiguous 0→1 spaces where I can own strategy as well as delivery, building design systems that become force multipliers for teams.

Experience

Percona
Senior Product Designer
August 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)
Leiria, Portugal

Impact & Strategy

- Contributed to the team effort of 45% PMM adoption growth through systematic UX improvements across product ecosystem
- Identified critical adoption barriers through user pathway analysis, shifting strategy from UI updates to ecosystem-wide improvements

- Delivered validated SaaS prototype in 2-week sprint securing executive investment
- Influenced executive strategy with compelling vision prototypes and extensive user research, securing buy-in for roadmap initiatives

Systems & Scale

- Built Peak Design System adopted across 3 products and 10+ engineers, reducing handoff and front-end development by ~50%
- Achieved near 100% implementation accuracy through self-serve components and developer tooling
- Established analytics framework (PostHog) enabling data-driven decisions across documentation and products

Technical Leadership

- Shipped production code for internal services platform, eliminating handoff friction
- Led documentation redesign across 10+ products, establishing patterns for consistent onboarding
- Initiated New Native Navigation project to reduce Grafana dependency, unblocking strategies against technical debt
- Mentored designers and engineers, establishing research practices, design excellence standards, and a modernized front-end practice

FARFETCH

Senior Product Designer

June 2021 - July 2022 (1 year 2 months)

Lisbon, Portugal

Business Impact & Research

- Led sustainability research revealing discovery barriers and supporting corporate sustainability goals
- Created taxonomy frameworks addressing catalog confusion while informing sustainability roadmap
- Enabled direct purchasing capability from listing pages through card redesign, removing unnecessary navigation steps

Systems & Process

- Developed testing protocols and comparison matrices adopted by multiple teams
- Built modular component patterns balancing luxury aesthetics with functional requirements
- Established documentation bridging design and catalog teams, reducing cross-team friction

Strategic Influence

- Research showed path and margin to grow conscious products improved discovery
- Shifted organizational narrative from “sustainability as cost center” to “sustainability as growth opportunity”
- Earned leadership recognition for cross-department alignment on sustainable product strategy

TUI

Senior Product Designer

March 2019 - May 2021 (2 years 3 months)

Lisbon, Portugal

Business Impact & Innovation

- Designed PageBuilder system generating 100K+ destination pages, supporting 4x organic traffic growth and reducing metasearch business dependence
- Influenced product strategy and roadmaps through data-driven vision prototypes earning executive recognition
- Co-founded TUI Lisbon hub, scaling the team while establishing innovation practices

Systems & Multi-Market Scale

- Created Tagus design system unifying experiences across 5 global markets
- Helped build a templating framework accelerating multi-market deployment
- Designed complete e-commerce flows from inspiration through checkout, standardized across markets

Technical & Process Leadership

- Partnered with distributed teams across European offices sharing rapid deployment methodologies
- Validated team approaches through A/B testing and Baymard benchmarking before scaling
- Managed external development partnerships ensuring high implementation quality

Noise Goods
Founder and Manager
June 2013 - August 2019 (6 years 3 months)
Leiria, Portugal

Business & Product Strategy

- Scaled accessories brand to 50+ countries through e-commerce and wholesale channels
- Managed complete product lifecycle from concept through manufacturing with Portuguese suppliers
- Secured international stockists and editorial features through strategic brand positioning

Technical & Digital

- Built custom e-commerce platform through front-end skills
- Optimized for international SEO and conversion through analytics-driven iteration
- Created sustainable supply chain balancing growth with environmental responsibility

SMARTIDIOM
User Experience Designer
May 2016 - March 2019 (2 years 11 months)
Leiria, Portugal

Product & Platform Development

- Designed and coded 4 interconnected products and showcased at CES 2017
- Secured European Community funding through compelling product demonstration and market validation
- Helped transform a traditional direct-servicing company into digital platform connecting customers with certified professionals

Technical Execution

- Delivered production front-end code in a lean 4-person team format
- Built component system from scratch enabling ~50-75% faster feature development
- Created platform micro-tools: calendar, finance tracking, bidding systems, ISO-compliant onboarding

Stricker
Product Designer
June 2010 - October 2013 (3 years 5 months)
Aveiro, Portugal

Product Development & Systems

- Designed 50+ B2B products using systematic approach to customization and categorization
- Established modular design systems enabling mass customization within the manufacturing constraints
- Conducted competitive analysis at international trade shows informing product strategy

Process & Impact

- Conducted field research at international trade shows, analyzing competitor offerings
- Developed user testing protocols reducing overseas production iterations by 25-50%
- Presented to C-level stakeholders securing buy-in for innovative product lines
- Established digital catalog foundations through information architecture work

Self-employed
Illustrator and Graphic Designer
September 2009 - June 2011 (1 year 10 months)
Lisbon, Portugal

- Published illustrations in leading Portuguese editorial publications
- Self-taught web technologies (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) bridging design and development
- Contributed to open-source communities while building technical foundation
- Produced marketing collaterals translating brand messages into compelling visual designs

- Designed brand identities with comprehensive guidelines for visual consistency

COMOPI Kitchen Design
Industrial Designer
September 2007 - September 2009 (2 years 1 month)
Coimbra, Portugal

- Designed modular furniture system enabling 3x faster production
- Benchmarked against industry leaders (Boffi, Bulthaup, Poggenpohl) elevating design quality
- Customized CAD software reducing design-to-production time by ~50-70%
- Pioneered digital pipeline connecting customer requirements directly to manufacturing parameters
- Led 15+ interior design projects translating lifestyle needs into functional kitchen solutions

Education

Escola Universitária das Artes de Coimbra
Master's Degree, Industrial and Product Design · (2002 - 2007)

Instituto Politécnico de Coimbra - Escola Superior de Educação
Multimedia Design · (2001 - 2002)

Escola Secundária José Falcão
High School, Tridimensional Design · (1998 - 2001)